

SATABDI MOHAPATRA

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ESG, Climate Finance & Sustainable Investment Specialist | ESG Ratings, SPOs', Climate Risk & Regulatory Advisory

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Sustainability, ESG & Climate Finance Professional with 12+ years of experience spanning sustainable agriculture, impact investing, ESG advisory, climate finance, and ESG ratings. Extensive experience advising corporates, financial institutions, investors, DFIs, MDBs, and development organizations on ESG strategy, sustainable finance, climate risk management, responsible investment, and climate transition. Skilled in developing and implementing ESG frameworks, sustainability strategies, GSS bond frameworks, ESG due diligence, impact assessments, and sustainability reporting across diverse sectors and emerging markets.

Well-versed in leading global sustainability frameworks and standards, including **IFRS S1 & S2, TCFD, GRI, CSRD, CDP, BRSR, PCAF, LEED, SASB, and the UN Global Compact**. Strong track record of helping organizations strengthen ESG performance, enhance regulatory compliance, manage climate-related risks, and integrate sustainability into business strategy and investment decision-making.

Demonstrated success in leading ESG ratings, climate finance, sustainable investment, and ESG advisory engagements while driving business growth, stakeholder engagement, methodology development, and practice expansion. Recognized for building high-performing teams, fostering strategic partnerships, and delivering innovative sustainability solutions that create measurable environmental, social, and business value.

CORE COMPETENCIES

ESG Strategy & Integration | Sustainability Reporting & Disclosures | ESG Ratings & SPOs | Climate Risk Assessment | Sustainable Finance & GSS Bonds | ESG Due Diligence | Climate Transition Planning | Responsible Investment | Financed Emissions & PCAF | GHG Accounting | Materiality Assessment | ESG Research & Analytics | Regulatory Compliance (IFRS S1/S2, TCFD, GRI, CSRD, BRSR, CDP) | Impact Measurement & Evaluation | Sustainable Agriculture & Climate Resilience | Stakeholder Engagement | Business Development | Team Leadership | Project & Practice Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aug 2025- Aug 2026 with CareEdge-ESG (CareEdge Group), Mumbai as Assistant Director

ESG Ratings, SPOs & Project Delivery:

- Led end-to-end delivery of **30+ ESG Ratings and 4 Second Party Opinion (SPO) engagements** across banking, infrastructure, power, metals & mining, real estate, capital goods, and diversified sectors
- Managed project planning, budgeting, resource allocation, quality assurance, and stakeholder communication while maintaining **100% regulatory compliance**.
- Supported clients in designing ESG governance committees, reporting structures, escalation mechanisms, decision rights and accountability matrices to embed ESG considerations into risk, business and compliance functions
- Successfully delivered ESG assessments for leading organizations including Adani Group companies, LIC, Bank of India, Union Bank of India, ACC, Ambuja, Grasim, Aditya Birla, Oberoi Realty, Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation (GMDC) and Lloyds Metals providing actionable recommendations, benchmarking against industry best practices, and developing **future ESG roadmaps** to strengthen sustainability performance, regulatory compliance, and long-term value creation.

Business Development & Revenue Growth:

- Secured **8 successful bids and strategic business proposals**, driving new client acquisition and revenue growth across the Indian market
- Developed and executed go-to-market strategies, strategic account plans, and channel partnerships, strengthening market presence and business expansion.
- Enhanced brand visibility and market positioning through thought leadership initiatives, industry forums, webinars, and client engagement programs.

Client Relationship & Stakeholder Management:

- Served as the primary relationship manager for senior sustainability and ESG leaders, building trusted partnerships and delivering high levels of client satisfaction.
- Successfully managed stakeholder engagement across clients, regulators, stock exchanges, and internal teams, ensuring seamless project execution and issue resolution.
- This is under the UK PACT programme, multiple clients supported across Africa, Asia and Latin America
- Spearheaded the **Business Today India's Most Sustainable Companies Awards**, serving as the Methodology Partner and developing the ESG evaluation framework and assessment methodology for **capital goods, real estate and oil & gas sector**.
- Built and managed strategic partnerships with Business Today, The Times of India, UN Global Compact (UNGC), Climate Bonds Initiative (CBI), International Capital Market Association (ICMA), and IFSCA to drive ESG thought leadership, sustainable finance initiatives, and industry engagement.

Methodology Development & Regulatory Compliance

- Developed and enhanced ESG rating methodologies, analytical frameworks, and rating models in alignment with evolving **SEBI regulations** and industry best practices.
- Prepared the **Second-Party Opinion (SPO) methodology** for **CareEdge ESG Ratings**, creating the internal assessment framework, evaluation criteria, and analytical guidance for reviewing sustainable finance instruments in line with **ICMA** and **LMA** principles, supporting the organization's sustainable finance offerings.
- Ensured timely regulatory filings, audit readiness, and adherence to stock exchange and regulatory requirements.
- Contributed technical inputs to the **CII Taskforce** for the Draft **Indian Climate Finance Taxonomy**, supporting climate-aligned and transition finance classifications.

Team Leadership & Practice Development:

- Built, mentored, and led a high-performing team of **12 analysts and 6 interns**, drove capability development, accountability, and delivery excellence.
- Fostered collaboration across analytics, advisory, legal, compliance & external stakeholder teams to deliver high-quality client outcomes
- Developed **knowledge assets, playbooks, templates, and best-practice frameworks** that improved project execution, consistency, and operational efficiency.

May 2024 - Jul 2025 with auctusESG, Mumbai as Senior Manager

ESG Reporting, Disclosure & Regulatory Alignment:

- Evaluated alignment with IFRS S1, IFRS S2, SEBI BRSR, and global disclosure standards by conducting ESG and sustainability assessments for Nifty 500 companies.
- Designed sustainability reporting frameworks for corporates, financial institutions and NBFCs, enhanced ESG transparency and stakeholder communication.
- Managed end-to-end sustainability reporting engagements for NBFCs and corporate clients, preparing disclosures aligned with GRI Standards, and TCFD recommendations, including **double materiality assessments**, ESG data management, stakeholder engagement, KPI development, and regulatory compliance.
- Conducted an **ESRS disclosure readiness study** for a financial sector client by performing detailed gap assessments to identify missing disclosures, data gaps, policy and target deficiencies, and areas requiring stronger evidence and internal controls. Subsequently, prepared a comprehensive report based on the Double Materiality Assessment , covering material impacts, risks and opportunities across the relevant ESRS topics.

Climate Finance & Sustainable Finance Advisory:

- Strengthened **climate adaptation financing capabilities** and supported the integration of adaptation finance into lending frameworks by leading technical assistance initiatives for leading financial institutions.
- Played a key role in a landmark climate finance project that contributed to the establishment of a **€100 million climate finance line of credit** between the French Development Agency (AFD) and the State Bank of India under the Green India Financial System (GIFS) initiative.
- Developed sustainability and climate finance strategies, including **Sustainability Bond Frameworks, climate finance roadmaps, and mitigation & adaptation finance screening methodologies** for banks and financial institutions.

Climate Risk, Research & Advisory:

- Spearheaded climate risk management and climate transition advisory projects for financial institutions and corporates, enabling proactive management of climate-related risks and opportunities.

- Led sectoral research, **climate risk assessments**, **double materiality analyses**, **transition finance** studies across multiple hard-to-abate sector.
- Delivered strategic recommendations on climate integration, policy interventions, sustainable finance & corporate transition readiness to various banks and FIs’.

Digital Transformation & Process Innovation:

- Improved the efficiency, accuracy, and scalability of financed emissions calculations, GHG accounting, Green Asset Ratio (GAR) assessments, and ESG due diligence activities by **leading automation of ESG data management processes**.

Thought Leadership & Capacity Building:

- Designed and delivered **10+ sustainable finance training programs** for financial institutions, regulators, policymakers, and industry professionals by strengthening sector-wide ESG and climate finance capabilities.
- Contributed to the development of sustainability knowledge assets, methodologies, and advisory frameworks to support evolving client and market requirements.

Business Development & Strategic Partnerships:

- Supported business growth through the development of **25+ concept notes**, **15+ RFPs**, and **5 EOIs**, contributing to multiple funded projects and a strong opportunity pipeline.
- Established **25+ strategic partnerships across APAC and the Middle East**, expanding market reach, collaboration opportunities, and business development prospect.

Jul 2021 - May 2024 with Institutional Shareholders Services (ISS STOXX), Mumbai as Associate (ESG Research)

- Authored **100+ ESG assessment reports** aligned with **UN Global Compact**, **IFC performance standards** and **OECD Guidelines**, supported institutional investors in responsible investment decisions.
- Assessed **250+ global ESG controversies** through norm-based research, supporting responsible investment decisions, ESG transparency, and controversy risk management.
- Conducted CSRD/ESRS-aligned ESG assessments of institutional investors’ portfolio companies, evaluating sustainability disclosures, policies, targets, governance practices and performance metrics across all **12 ESRS standards**.
- Acted as **ESG Topic Specialist** for environmental, labour, health & safety, and biodiversity issues, evaluating alignment with international standards and identifying key sustainability and reputational risks.
- Conducted analysis of **250+ ESG controversies** involving global companies such as Meta, Amazon, Shell, Arcelor Mittal and Inditex, identifying material sustainability and governance risks.
- Strengthened ESG research quality and consistency by contributing to the enhancement of proprietary research methodologies
- Delivered actionable **ESG insights** that supported portfolio risk assessment and investment decision-making for clients across EMEA, APAC, North & South America region.

Nov 2019-Jun 2021 with Solidaridad Network, New Delhi as Assistant Manager (Impact Investing)

- Designed **innovative impact investment frameworks** for sustainable agriculture and sustainable landscapes, mobilizing investor interest and supporting climate-resilient and inclusive rural development.
- Developed **impact measurement and reporting frameworks** aligned with **GIIN IRIS+** and global impact investing practices to strengthen monitoring, evaluation, and investor reporting for development programmes.
- Contributed to the design of the **NISCOPS programme**, promoting sustainable and inclusive practices among oil palm smallholders while integrating gender, climate resilience, and livelihood enhancement.
- Led the India operations of the **INDUS Forum**, onboarding over 60 participants and facilitating 10+ strategic partnerships and business collaborations across sustainability value chains.
- Led assessments of **living wages and social sustainability** across cotton supply chains by applying globally recognized frameworks, including the **Higg Index**, **SA8000**, and internationally accepted **living wage methodologies**, generating evidence-based recommendations to strengthen responsible sourcing, improve labour standards, and enhance supply chain sustainability.
- Developed research, investment frameworks, and practical toolkits on impact investing, financial inclusion, gender-lens investing, sustainable finance, and blended finance for development partners and investors.
- Supported the design of investment strategies for **sustainable landscapes and socio-ecological poverty** reduction, helping attract impact capital for landscape restoration, climate resilience, and inclusive livelihoods.
- Led stakeholder engagement, strategic planning, and knowledge management initiatives with governments, financial institutions, corporates, and development organizations, improving programme effectiveness and scaling impact.
- Prepared and reviewed **investment term sheets**, **investor pitch decks**, and **investment proposals**, supporting fundraising, due diligence, and capital mobilization for **impact investment** and sustainable agriculture initiatives.

- Served as a member of the **Gender Taskforce at Solidaridad Asia**, designing programmes and integrating gender-responsive approaches across sustainable agriculture, responsible supply chains, and women's economic empowerment initiatives.

Feb 2017 - Oct 2019 with Development Alternatives, New Delhi as Deputy Manager, Agribusiness

Sustainable Agriculture & Climate Resilience

- Served as Agriculture Specialist across **15+ projects** focused on climate-resilient agriculture, regenerative farming, integrated farming systems, and rural livelihood enhancement
- Improved farmer livelihoods and resilience in climate-vulnerable regions by leading climate adaptation, sustainable agriculture, and natural resource management initiatives
- Conducted **Technology Needs Assessments (TNA)** for climate change adaptation across **four Indian states**, supported evidence-based climate planning and policy development
- Led research and technical assessments on **land remediation through a natural capital approach** to support the achievement of national and global environmental targets. Assessed **ecosystem services**, identified degradation patterns, drivers, and environmental pressures, conducted **cost-benefit analyses** of restoration interventions, and developed policy recommendations to enhance ecosystem resilience, sustainable land management, and long-term socio-economic benefits.

Research, Policy & Impact Assessment:

- Contributed to high-impact research projects with international partners including the **University of Edinburgh, German Government, and ICRISAT**, covering agroforestry, land restoration, natural capital, and agricultural development interventions
- Co-authored research and policy papers on sustainable agriculture, food systems, and food governance, contributing to national and global sustainability discussions

FPO Development & Capacity Building

- Enhanced enterprise viability and farmer incomes to develop strategic roadmaps, business plans, and market linkage strategies for **Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs)**
- Designed and delivered training programs on climate-smart agriculture, water management, and sustainable farming practices for farmers, institutions, and extension workers

Program Leadership & Monitoring:

- Served as **Co-Thematic Lead – Natural Resource Management**, supporting program strategy, monitoring & evaluation, impact assessment, and knowledge management
- Led project design, results frameworks, indicator development, and performance tracking systems to strengthen program effectiveness and measurable impact

PREVIOUS ASSIGNMENTS

KDI School of Public Policy and Management, South Korea	Research Assistant	Oct 2016 - Dec 2016
Syngenta, Bhubaneswar, Odisha	Sales Unit Lead	Aug 2014 - Dec 2015
DuPont, Bhubaneswar, Odisha	Marketing Coordinator	Apr 2013 - Jul 2014

ACADEMIC CREDENTIALS

2024-2026 (Pursuing)	MBA, Executive Post Graduate Program in Management from IIM Kozhikode
2016-2017	Master's in Development policy (MDP), at KDI School of Public Policy and Management, South Korea
2011-2013	PGDM (Agribusiness Management) from National Academy of Agricultural Research Management, ICAR, Hyderabad
2007-2011	Bachelors in Agricultural Sciences (BSc. Ag.) from College of Agriculture, Orissa University of Agriculture & Technology (OUAT), Bhubaneswar

MEMBERSHIPS

- Group Member for **technical development of Standards for Trees Outside Forest**, Network of Certification and Conservation of Forests
- Member of "Revitalizing Rained Agriculture" group watershed support services and activities network
- Member of "Friends of Baika Beal" wetland and sanctuary
- Short term consulting work for Indian Social Responsibility Network (ISRN)

- Short term consulting work for Haqdarshak, a social enterprise working to improve socio economic conditions and elevate standard of living of communities by ensuring “last mile” service delivery of government welfare and financial services
- Working group member for **IUCN Nature Based solution (NBS)** methodology development in 2019, case study writer for NBS at conference in Dhaka
- Working group member for the **India UK Water Centre** in 2019 for promoting long- term partnerships and dialogue between Indian and UK water researchers, policy makers and businesses

CERTIFICATIONS

- Climate Risk and Sustainable Finance, Indian Institute of Banking & Finance (IIBF)
- Foundations in Responsible Investment Principles for Responsible Investment (PRI)
- Corporate standard, Scope 2 and corporate value chain GHG Protocol
- Learning Design for sustainability Project Management Institute (PMI)
- Introduction to Scenario analysis TCFD Knowledge hub online learning
- Introduction to data sciences in Python Coursera
- ISO 14064 Lead Verifier Certification

PERSONAL DOSSIER

Current Address: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

Permanent Address: Bhubaneswar, Odisha **Languages:**
English, Hindi and Odia